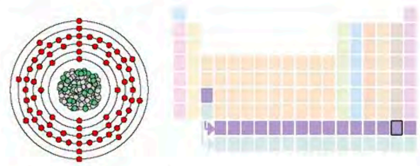
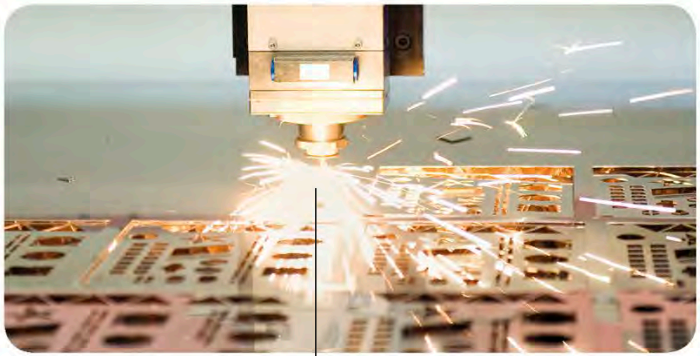
70
Yb
Ytterbium



70 70 103 State: Solid
Discovery: 1878

Ytterbium tends to be more reactive than other lanthanide metals. It is stored in sealed containers to stop the metal from reacting with oxygen. The **pure metal** has only a few uses. A small amount of ytterbium is used in making steel, while its compounds are used in some **lasers**.

Laser cutting



***An ytterbium laser** can cut through metals and plastics.*

Laboratory sample of pure ytterbium

***This bright, shiny metal** can be hammered into thin sheets.*

71
Lu
Lutetium

71 71 104 State: Solid
Discovery: 1907

Laboratory sample of pure lutetium

***This element** is the hardest and densest lanthanide metal.*

Lutetium was the last of the rare earth metals to be discovered. It is also the final member of the lanthanides. In its **pure form**, lutetium is very reactive and catches fire easily. It is rare and has few uses, mainly as a substance mixed with crude **oil**.

Oil refinery

***Some oil refineries** use lutetium to break down crude oil to make fuels, such as petrol and diesel.*